

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 17)

Page 82 - The Age of Milton and Puritanism

Q1. What period of time does the 'Age of Milton' cover in the text?

- A. 1558-1603
- B. 1603-1625
- C. 1625-1660
- D. 1660-1700

Answer: C

Q2. What is the principal historical feature of the Age of Milton for the student of literature?

- A. The rise of the British Empire in India
- B. The growth of Puritanism as a moral/social force and its establishment as the controlling power in the state
- C. The Renaissance reaching its absolute peak
- D. The beginning of the Industrial Revolution

Answer: B

Q3. Why were radicals dissatisfied with the religious settlement accomplished by Archbishop Parker during the Reformation?

- A. They felt it was too radical
- B. They held that the Church of England did not differ sufficiently from the Church of Rome
- C. They wanted to reinstate the Pope
- D. They wanted entirely secular government

Answer: B

Q4. Which famous figure from Geneva greatly influenced these dissentients?

- A. Martin Luther
- B. John Calvin
- C. Thomas Aquinas
- D. Erasmus

Answer: B

Q5. What were these dissentients united in their hostility toward?

- A. The King and Parliament

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- B. The episcopal form of ecclesiastical government and remnants of Popery in public worship
- C. The translation of the Bible
- D. Scientific discovery

Answer: B

Q6. Because they advocated very strict views concerning life and conduct, what did these dissentients come to be called?

- A. Anglicans
- B. Catholics
- C. Puritans
- D. Methodists

Answer: C

Q7. How did the name 'Puritan' originate around the year of Shakespeare's birth?

- A. As a title of high honor
- B. It was at first used in derision, though soon accepted as a descriptive term
- C. It was given to them by the Pope
- D. They coined it themselves in a manifesto

Answer: B

Q8. During whose reign did the uncompromising spirit of the Puritans spread steadily among the middle classes?

- A. Henry VIII
- B. Queen Mary
- C. James I
- D. Charles II

Answer: C

Q9. Was it during the reign of James I that Puritanism emerged as a great national power?

- A. Yes, he championed their cause
- B. No, it was not till the time of his successor (Charles I) that it emerged as a great national power
- C. Yes, he converted to Puritanism
- D. No, it didn't emerge until the 18th century

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Answer: B

Q10. Who were the true descendants of Wyclif and the Lollards?

- A. The Jesuits
- B. The Puritans
- C. The Royalists
- D. The Humanists

Answer: B

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Page 83 - The Rise of Puritanism

Q1. What behavior of the upper classes helped increase the moral and social influence of Puritanism?

- A. Their extreme piety
- B. Their fast-growing flippancy and profligacy, which drew serious men to the Puritan side
- C. Their dedication to public education
- D. Their support of foreign wars

Answer: B

Q2. Whose high-handed policy and determination to enforce his will by persecution brought all enemies of episcopacy into line?

- A. Archbishop Parker
- B. Archbishop Laud
- C. Oliver Cromwell
- D. King James I

Answer: B

Q3. What actions by King Charles I made the Puritans intolerant of earthly tyranny?

- A. His conversion to Catholicism
- B. His monstrous encroachments upon the rights of the Commons and constitutional privileges of the people
- C. His refusal to go to war
- D. His abdication of the throne

Answer: B

Q4. What role did Puritanism play during this critical time in England's history?

- A. It became a political force and the great custodian and defender of jeopardised liberties
- B. It allied with Spain to destroy England
- C. It surrendered all power to the King
- D. It focused solely on writing poetry

Answer: A

Q5. With whose triumph did Puritanism become supreme during the Commonwealth?

- A. King Charles I

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- B. Oliver Cromwell
- C. John Milton
- D. Archbishop Laud

Answer: B

Q6. How does the author characterize the spirit that Puritanism introduced to English life?

- A. Fine and noble, but hard and stern
- B. Joyful and romantic
- C. Completely chaotic and lawless
- D. Purely scientific and rational

Answer: A

Q7. While admiring the Puritan's integrity, what does the author deplore about them?

- A. Their lack of religious faith
- B. Their fanaticism, moroseness, and the narrowness of their outlook and sympathies
- C. Their love of the theater
- D. Their cowardice in battle

Answer: B

Q8. How did Puritanism generally view the science, art, knowledge, and beauty of secular life?

- A. It championed and funded them
- B. It generally neglected, and often expressly denounced them
- C. It tried to merge them with religion
- D. It ignored them completely without comment

Answer: B

Q9. What effect did Puritanism have on humane culture and literature?

- A. It destroyed humane culture and was almost fatal to literature
- B. It caused a golden age of literature
- C. It had absolutely no effect on literature
- D. It only promoted comedic plays

Answer: A

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Q10. Who was the greatest product of Puritanism in English literature, able to transcend its limitations?

- A. Oliver Cromwell
- B. John Milton
- C. John Bunyan
- D. Thomas Hobbes

Answer: B

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Page 84 - John Milton's Early Life

Q1. In what way did Milton's work differ from strict Puritanism?

- A. It was entirely Catholic
- B. The moral and religious influences of Puritanism were combined with the generous culture of the Renaissance
- C. He rejected religion entirely
- D. He wrote only about political strategy

Answer: B

Q2. When and where was John Milton born?

- A. 9th December 1608, in London
- B. 1564, in Stratford-on-Avon
- C. 1625, in Cambridge
- D. 1599, in Oxford

Answer: A

Q3. Despite being strongly Puritan, what did Milton's father love, which gave the child a cultivated home?

- A. Hunting and sports
- B. Literature and art
- C. Foreign travel
- D. Military history

Answer: B

Q4. Where was Milton educated?

- A. St. Paul's School and Christ's College, Cambridge
- B. Westminster School and Oxford
- C. Eton and the University of Paris
- D. He was entirely self-taught

Answer: A

Q5. Why did Milton decide not to enter the church, as had been intended for him?

- A. He failed his theology exams

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- B. He realized he could not conscientiously enter it, deciding instead to give himself up to self-culture and poetry
- C. He was banished by the King
- D. The church refused to accept him

Answer: B

Q6. Where did Milton spend six years of almost uninterrupted seclusion pursuing his studies?

- A. In a monastery in France
- B. In the country house of his family at Horton, Buckinghamshire
- C. In a small apartment in London
- D. In a castle in Scotland

Answer: B

Q7. What was the result of Milton's untiring devotion to learning during his youth and time at Horton?

- A. He went mad
- B. He became a very great scholar, standing head and shoulders above all our other poets in erudition
- C. He forgot how to write poetry
- D. He became a famous scientist

Answer: B

Q8. Why must Milton's scholarship be carefully marked when studying his poetry?

- A. Because his poetry is entirely scientific
- B. Because his learning everywhere nourishes and interpenetrates his poetic work
- C. Because he wrote all his poetry in Greek
- D. Because he only wrote about history

Answer: B

Q9. Where did Milton go in May 1638 to complete his studies by travel?

- A. America
- B. Spain
- C. Italy (by way of Paris)
- D. Germany

Answer: C

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Q10. Why was Milton prematurely recalled from his travels in Italy?

- A. He ran out of money
- B. News of the civil commotions in England; he thought it base to travel for amusement while his fellow-citizens fought for liberty
- C. His father died
- D. He was expelled by the Italian government

Answer: B

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Page 85 - Milton's Adulthood and Early Poetry

Q1. From 1640 onward, what cause was Milton increasingly active in supporting?

- A. The Royalist cause
- B. The Puritan cause against the Royalists
- C. The French Revolution
- D. The Spanish Inquisition

Answer: B

Q2. What position was Milton appointed to on the establishment of the Commonwealth?

- A. Prime Minister
- B. Latin Secretary to the Committee for Foreign Affairs
- C. Archbishop of Canterbury
- D. Lord Chancellor

Answer: B

Q3. What terrible calamity overtook Milton early in 1653, ruined by over-stress of work?

- A. He went deaf
- B. He became totally blind
- C. He lost the use of his hands
- D. He contracted the plague

Answer: B

Q4. What happened to Milton upon the restoration of the monarchy?

- A. He was executed
- B. He was made Poet Laureate
- C. He was arrested and two of his books were publicly burnt by the hangman, but he was soon released
- D. He fled to America

Answer: C

Q5. When were Milton's greatest works (Paradise Lost, Paradise Regained, Samson Agonistes) published?

- A. During his youth at Cambridge
- B. During his time at Horton (1632-1638)

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- C. During the Commonwealth when he was Latin Secretary
- D. Late in his life (1667 and 1671), while he was blind, poor, and lonely

Answer: D

Q6. When did John Milton die?

- A. 8th November 1674
- B. 1653
- C. 1660
- D. 1700

Answer: A

Q7. How many periods does Milton's work naturally fall into?

- A. Two
- B. Three
- C. Four
- D. Five

Answer: C

Q8. Which poem is noted as a very remarkable production from his first (college) period?

- A. Paradise Lost
- B. Ode On the Morning of Christ's Nativity
- C. L'Allegro
- D. Lycidas

Answer: B

Q9. Which period contains four minor poems of such beauty they would have placed him high among English poets even without Paradise Lost?

- A. The college period
- B. The Horton period (1632-1638)
- C. The period of prose writings
- D. The late poetic period

Answer: B

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Q10. Name the four great minor poems written during the Horton period.

A. Paradise Lost, Paradise Regained, Samson Agonistes, Areopagitica

B. L'Allegro, Il Penseroso, Comus, Lycidas

C. Hamlet, Othello, King Lear, Macbeth

D. Euphues, Arcadia, Astrophel, Amoretti

Answer: B

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Page 86 - Milton's Horton Poems

Q1. Read in the order of their writing, what do the Horton poems show taking place in Milton's mind?

- A. A complete rejection of all religion
- B. A profound change where the Puritan element gradually gained strength until it became dominant
- C. A growing obsession with science
- D. A desire to write only prose

Answer: B

Q2. Under what inspiration did Milton chiefly begin to write his earlier poetry?

- A. Strict Puritan theology
- B. The learning and art of the Renaissance
- C. The scientific revolution
- D. Medieval Catholicism

Answer: B

Q3. How do L'Allegro and Il Penseroso (the earliest of the Horton poems) reflect Puritanism?

- A. They are strictly Puritan and denounce all pleasure
- B. There is little that is characteristically Puritan, and much that is un-puritan (dwelling on romance, the playhouse, etc.)
- C. They are religious sermons in verse
- D. They call for the execution of the King

Answer: B

Q4. Which poem marks a distinct stage in the development of Milton's mind, where the Puritan spirit makes its influence felt?

- A. L'Allegro
- B. Il Penseroso
- C. Comus
- D. On the Morning of Christ's Nativity

Answer: C

Q5. On the literary side, what type of Renaissance drama is 'Comus' an example of?

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- A. A Senecan tragedy
- B. A Comedy of Manners
- C. A Mask (or Masque)
- D. A Miracle Play

Answer: C

Q6. From where had the 'Mask' been brought into England?

- A. France
- B. Italy
- C. Spain
- D. Germany

Answer: B

Q7. What does Milton's willingness to write a Mask (Comus) prove about his views at the time?

- A. That he hated the Renaissance
- B. That he was still far from sharing the intense hostility of the Puritan party to everything connected with the drama
- C. That he wanted to be a professional actor
- D. That he was fully committed to the Royalist cause

Answer: B

Q8. Though written in the form of Renaissance art, what did Milton fill 'Comus' with?

- A. A strenuous moral spirit and meaning
- B. Coarse jokes and slapstick comedy
- C. Purely political propaganda
- D. Meaningless rhetorical devices

Answer: A

Q9. In the story of Comus, who lures away the lady lost in the woods?

- A. A dragon
- B. Comus and his band of revellers
- C. A wicked witch
- D. The King of Faery

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Answer: B

Q10. Who rescues the lady in Comus?

- A. A passing knight
- B. Her brothers with the help of an attendant spirit
- C. The King
- D. She rescues herself

Answer: B